

The lawn at *sunset*, and the people in it

One day to capture what the photographs so far do not show: guests enjoying the restaurant and the lawns, food at the table, and the estate in the last hour of light.

Saturday 19 Sep

Weather permitting

Sunrise 06:01 · Sunset 18:01

Randjesfontein, Midrand

WHY THIS SHOOT

We have the place. We need it in use.

The Acreage already has beautiful professional photographs of the venue, the plated food and the drinks, almost all of them without people. What social media, advertising and the new website need now is the same setting with life in it: people at the tables, food arriving, light on the lawn. Everything from this day will be used on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, in paid ads and on the website.

THE LOOK

Elegant, soft and natural.

Warm natural light, an airy feel, and people caught mid-moment rather than posed. The images below are from The Acreage's own library and show the light and mood to aim for.



Soft backlight, the lawn blurred behind.



Delicate detail, soft window light.



Long light across the grass.



A dressed table. Next time, with the guests at it.

Natural light

Candid

Florals and linen

Soft, warm tones

Space around the subject

Hands and movement

Heavy, dark edits

Stiff posed smiles

Flash

Glittered backgrounds

THE DAY

Three blocks, following the light.

07:30

SET UP

Walk the estate and dress the tables

Flowers on the tables, linen napkins, polished glassware. Clear bins, cables, stacked chairs and stray signage out of the main angles.

08:00 to 10:30

BLOCK ONE

Breakfast, people and dogs

The light is soft until about ten. Guests eating on the lawn and the deck, coffee being made and poured, a family, a dog under a table.

10:30 to 12:30

BLOCK TWO

Food at the table, the kitchen and the team

Plates going down in front of guests, the pass, a chef at work, the bar and front of house. Shoot food in use, outdoors where possible, rather than on its own.

12:30 to 16:00

BREAK

Harsh midday light

Only interior details if needed. Kitchen closes mid-afternoon, so any remaining plates are done before then.

16:15 to 18:01

BLOCK THREE

Drinks, friends and golden hour

A group of friends at a dressed table, drinks at sunset, then people on the lawn backlit and in silhouette as the sun drops. Sunset is at 18:01.

18:01 to 18:25

BLUE HOUR

Lights on

The restaurant, lapa and tents glowing against a dark blue sky. Twenty minutes, and worth staying for.

If the photographer can only do half a day, book 14:30 to 18:30. That covers late lunch plates before the kitchen closes, drinks and people through the afternoon, and golden hour. The breakfast shots can then be a second, shorter session another morning.

THE SHOT LIST

Twenty frames.

The format column shows which shapes each shot has to work in. Shots marked "Also for ads" are the ones the advertising depends on. Shoot every frame upright as well as horizontal: vertical is what Stories, Reels, TikTok and most ads use, and a vertical frame can be cropped to a feed post, while a horizontal one cannot become a good Story.

01	Two people eating breakfast on the lawn, mid-conversation Not looking at the camera. Plates visible but not the subject. The single most important frame on this list.	4:5 + 9:16 ALSO FOR ADS
02	Hands, coffee being poured, steam Tight and close. Shoot it three or four ways.	9:16 ALSO FOR ADS
03	A family of four at a table, children included The kids' menu exists, and families are a main audience. There is no photograph yet that says children are welcome.	4:5 ALSO FOR ADS
04	A child with a milkshake or a dessert The milkshakes and desserts are already photographed beautifully. The child is what is missing, and it is the frame that gets shared.	4:5 + 9:16 ALSO FOR ADS
05	A full breakfast plate being put down in front of someone Over the shoulder, the server's hands in frame. Movement rather than a styled still.	4:5
06	The menu being read at a table Says breakfast is served all day without needing a caption.	4:5
07	A dog under a table, the owner's legs in frame The one Bring the Dog photo that has to be your own, not saved from someone else.	4:5 + 9:16 ALSO FOR ADS
08	A dog on the lawn with the lake behind Wide, with the estate doing the selling.	4:5
09	A water bowl being put down for a dog A small detail that proves dogs are welcomed, not tolerated.	9:16
10	The kitchen mid-service, a chef working Faces. People behind the food.	4:5 + 9:16 ALSO FOR ADS
11	The pass, plates going out Movement and heat. Film it as well as photographing it.	9:16 VIDEO ALSO FOR ADS
12	Front of house greeting an arriving table The welcome, which is what your reviews talk about.	4:5
13	A barista or bartender making something, hands and face Sells the bar hours after the kitchen closes.	9:16
14	Jade and Andrew on the lawn, together One good frame of both owners, used sparingly.	4:5
15	A table of eight or ten, full, mid-meal Proves the restaurant takes a group. Function bookers look for exactly this.	4:5 ALSO FOR ADS

16 A dressed long table before guests arrive, then the same table full

4:5 + 16:9

If a real function is on the day of the shoot, photograph that instead, with the client's permission.

ALSO FOR ADS

17 People on the lawn at golden hour, backlit, in silhouette

9:16 + 4:5

Beautiful, and nobody is identifiable, which keeps permissions simple.

ALSO FOR ADS

18 Drinks on a table at sunset, people blurred behind

4:5

Sells the occasion, not just the view.

19 The braai or fire pit in use

9:16 VIDEO

Needed for every function and year-end promotion.

ALSO FOR ADS

20 Arrival: the gate, the drive, the first view of the estate

9:16 VIDEO

Answers what it is like to get there. Also the first two seconds of every Reel.

ALSO FOR ADS

THE TECHNICAL SIDE

Formats, video and delivery.

Photographs

- **Both orientations** for every key frame, with room around the subject so it can be cropped.
- Leave **clear space at the top** of some frames, for a headline or price.
- Full-resolution JPEG, colour-edited to the soft, natural look above, **no watermark**.



Video clips

- **Filmed upright**, 4K or 1080p at 25 or 30 frames a second.
- **Hold each shot for ten seconds**, steady, on a gimbal or tripod.
- **Sound on**. Real sound from the day, no music added.
- The three shots whose format says video, the pass, the braai and the arrival, plus a slow walk through the restaurant and one of the lapa.

Delivery

- Into **The Acreage's shared Google Drive folder**, never over WhatsApp, which shrinks the files.
- **Twenty selects within 48 hours**, so the best frames can go on the website and social media straight away.
- The full edited set within five working days, with the raw video clips.

Usage rights, in writing

- The Acreage may use every image and clip **without time limit** on social media, in **paid advertising**, on the website and in print.
- Agreed with the photographer **before the day**, with the rate.
- The photographer may use the work in their own portfolio.

PEOPLE

Guests who have said yes.

Real guests may not want to be photographed, and anyone who appears in an advert has to agree to it. The simplest route is to invite a few tables of friends, regulars or team families for the morning and for sunset, and to ask everyone recognisable to sign a short release. Silhouettes and shots from behind need no release.

Four tables to invite

- A couple, for breakfast on the lawn.
- A family with young children.
- Three or four friends, for brunch or sunset drinks.
- A guest with a well-behaved dog.

A release, in plain words

Suggested wording for a one-line sign-off sheet with name, signature and date:

"I agree that The Acreage may use photographs and video of me taken on 19 September 2026 on its website, social media and advertising."

BEFORE SATURDAY

The checklist for The Acreage.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Photographer booked, with the rate and usage rights confirmed in writing | ☐ Team in clean uniform, and the chef and bar staff happy to be photographed |
| ☐ This brief sent to the photographer | ☐ Lawn cut, and bins, cables and stacked furniture cleared from view |
| ☐ Four tables invited, and the release sheet printed | ☐ A shared Google Drive folder created for the files |
| ☐ Fresh flowers and linen napkins for the tables | ☐ One person named to look after the photographer on the day |
| ☐ The kitchen told which dishes to plate, and when | ☐ Forecast checked on Thursday 17 September |

If the weather turns, overcast light is fine, even flattering, for breakfast, food and people, so blocks one and two can go ahead. Sunset needs a clear evening: move block three to Sunday 20 September (sunset 18:01) or Saturday 26 September (sunset 18:04).